Different colour combinations

Brown + red

How it feels

Brick and wine. Red gives brown a heart and brown gives red calm. Together they look like a brick house or dry wine in a wooden crate.

When it suits

When you want **warmth and strength**.

Specific shades



brown + red
warmly



chocolate + burgundy
deeply



beige + coral
earthily



caramel + scarlet
boldly



linen + brick
subduedly

In practice

A red scarf on a brown coat. A brick wall and a wooden table.

Watch out

Two warm colours easily make a heavy whole. Give one of them **more space**.

Brown + orange

How it feels

Autumn and oven. Orange warms brown up. Together they recall leaves, pumpkins and freshly baked bread.

When it suits

When you want **warmth and cosiness**.

Specific shades



brown + orange
warmly



chocolate + terracotta
richly



beige + apricot
softly



caramel + pumpkin
daringly



linen + rust
earthily

In practice

A rust cushion on a brown sofa. Pumpkin and chocolate in a kitchen.

Watch out

A whole that is too dense. Add **a light element**.

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Brown + yellow

How it feels

Honey and grain. Yellow lights brown up and brown gives yellow depth. Together they look like a field or mustard on bread.

When it suits

When you want **warm lightness**.

Specific shades


brown + yellow
sunnily


chocolate + ochre
golden


beige + butter
kindly


caramel + lemon
radiantly


linen + mustard
subduedly

In practice

A yellow tablecloth on a wooden table. A mustard jumper and brown boots.

Watch out

At similar saturation both are muted. Keep one **lighter**.

Brown + green

How it feels

Forest and bark. Green and brown are a natural pair. A tree, moss and soil, nobody blinks at that.

When it suits

When you want **a natural and calm impression**.

Specific shades


brown + green
naturally


chocolate + bottle green
woodland


beige + mint
freshly


caramel + emerald
earthily


linen + sage
quietly

In practice

A green plant in a brown pot. Wooden furniture and olive textiles.

Watch out

A sharp green next to a rich brown sounds loud. **Mute** the green.

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Brown + blue

How it feels

Soil and sky. Blue cools brown and brown warms blue. Together they look like jeans on wood.

When it suits

When you want **calm and stability**.

Specific shades



brown + blue
calmly



chocolate + dark blue
deeply



beige + sky
airily



caramel + cobalt
freshly



linen + denim
soberly

In practice

A blue jumper and brown boots. A light blue wall and wooden furniture.

Watch out

Both tend to be calm. Without light the whole can be **drowsy**.

Brown + indigo

How it feels

Depth and earth. Indigo gives brown seriousness and brown gives indigo warmth. Together they look like an old denim coat and a leather bag.

When it suits

When you want **depth and firmness**.

Specific shades



brown + indigo
at dusk



chocolate + ink
deeply



beige + twilight blue
firmly



caramel + ultramarine
dramatically



linen + grey-indigo
soberly

In practice

Indigo fabric on a brown sofa. A navy coat and brown gloves.

Watch out

Dark and dark blend. Add **a light colour**.

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Brown + violet

How it feels

Plum and wine. Purple gives brown dreaminess and brown gives purple ground. Together they recall ripe fruit and wood.

When it suits

When you want **sensuality and depth**.

Specific shades


brown + purple
earthily


chocolate + plum
sensually


beige + lavender
deeply


caramel + orchid
mysteriously


linen + grey-violet
dustily

In practice

A plum cushion on a brown armchair. Lavender flowers in a brown vase.

Watch out

A too veiled and stuffy whole. Add **a light colour**.

Brown + pink

How it feels

Wood and porcelain. Pink softens brown. Together they look like a peony on an old table.

When it suits

When you want **earthiness with softness**.

Specific shades


brown + pink
softly


chocolate + raspberry
deeply


beige + powder
powderily


caramel + fuchsia
autumnally


linen + old rose
naturally

In practice

An old-rose cushion on a brown armchair. Powder and chocolate in a bedroom.

Watch out

A too sweet whole. Add **wood or linen**.

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Brown + grey

How it feels

Stone and bark. Grey mutes brown and makes it urban. Together they look tasteful and sober.

When it suits

When you want **calm and elegance**.

Specific shades



brown + grey
soberly



chocolate + graphite
elegantly



beige + silver
lightly



caramel + slate
modernly



linen + dove
quietly

In practice

A grey coat and brown boots. A grey wall and a wooden table.

Watch out

A cold grey with a dark brown feels **gloomy**. Try a warmer material.

Brown + white

How it feels

A clean sheet. White brightens brown and gives it space. Together they look like coffee with milk.

When it suits

When you want **purity and lightness**.

Specific shades



brown + white
cleanly



chocolate + ivory
elegantly



beige + snow
freshly



caramel + milk
strikingly



linen + bone
gently

In practice

A white kitchen with a wooden worktop. A white shirt and a brown leather bag.

Watch out

Too much white can feel **clinical**. Add wood or linen.

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Brown + black

How it feels

Depth and contrast. Black makes brown a bold colour. Together they look serious, but with warmth.

When it suits

When you want **expression and depth**.

Specific shades

- brown + black — *dramatically*
- chocolate + charcoal — *deeply*
- beige + anthracite — *soberly*
- caramel + ink black — *elegantly*
- linen + soot — *discreetly*

In practice

A black jacket and brown boots. A black kitchen unit and a wooden worktop.

Watch out

Two dark colours tend to be heavy. Add **white or cream**.

Brown + gold

How it feels

Caramel and shine. Gold highlights brown and gives it shine. Together they look festive, like chocolate in gold foil.

When it suits

When you want **celebration with warmth**.

Specific shades

- brown + gold — *festively*
- chocolate + antique gold — *richly*
- beige + champagne — *gently*
- caramel + rich gold — *radiantly*
- linen + matte gold — *subduedly*

In practice

Gold jewellery on a brown jumper. A leather wallet with gold lettering.

Watch out

In excess gold drowns out ordinary comfort and the space recalls **a shop window**.

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A SIMPLE RULE

- When you want to **lighten** brown, add **white**, **cream**, **linen** or **light wood**.
- When you want to **bring it to life**, add **green**, **orange** or **yellow**.
- When you want to **soften** it, **pink**, **beige** or **caramel** will help.
- When you want to **deepen** it, add **black**, **gold** or **indigo**.

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